

FounderConsole.ai

Email Audit, Trigger Map & Redesign Strategy

Prepared for Vishesh Khurana | March 2026

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1. Executive Summary

FounderConsole.ai currently sends approximately 10 types of emails across transactional, notification, and fundraising automation categories. After auditing the platform, reviewing emails received by users, and benchmarking against B2B SaaS best practices, the findings are clear: the platform has a solid foundation in fundraising automation but critical gaps in lifecycle emails that directly impact activation, retention, and expansion revenue.

Current State Snapshot

Category	Emails Found	Status	Assessment
Transactional	0-1 (welcome implied)	CRITICAL GAP	No password reset, no email verification, no account changes
Onboarding	0	CRITICAL GAP	No activation sequence. 86% of users decide in first week
Alert / Notification	3 (daily, weekly, threshold alerts)	PARTIAL	Good alert system. No email preferences page. No unsubscribe.
Fundraising Automation	5 (cold outreach, follow-up, DD, updates, re-engage)	STRONG	Most mature category. 38% open rate on cold outreach.
Engagement / Feature	0	CRITICAL GAP	No feature adoption, no milestone celebrations, no tips
Billing / Payment	0	CRITICAL GAP	No payment receipts, no failed payment dunning, no plan changes
Re-engagement	1 (investor re-engage, inactive)	PARTIAL	Investor re-engagement exists but no user re-engagement

Bottom line: FounderConsole is missing approximately 32 email triggers that B2B SaaS best practices consider essential. The fundraising email automation is the strongest module, but the absence of onboarding, billing, and engagement emails means the platform is leaving significant activation and retention value on the table.

2. Audit of Existing Emails

Through platform exploration and email inbox analysis, the following 10 email types were identified as currently active or configured in FounderConsole:

Existing Email Inventory

#	Email Type	Sender	Trigger	Format	Issues
1	Weekly Briefing	team@founderconsole.ai	Manual button click on /alerts page	Plain text, financial summary	Manual trigger only. Should be automated on a schedule. No HTML template.
2	Daily Briefing	Unknown (in-app)	Appears on dashboard; email delivery unclear	Banner on /overview + modal	May not actually send an email. Only visible in-app. Needs email counterpart.
3	Burn Spike Alert	System (implied)	Monthly burn increases >15%	In-app notification	No confirmed email delivery. Only bell icon notification seen.
4	MRR Drop Alert	System (implied)	MRR drops >5%	In-app notification	Same issue. Alerts exist in-app but email delivery not confirmed.
5	Churn/Runway /Growth Alerts	System (implied)	Configurable thresholds (4 more types)	In-app notification	All 6 alert types have in-app config but no email toggle visible.
6	Cold Outreach Drip	User's email (fundraising)	Automated 4-step sequence over 14 days	156 sent, 38% open rate	Active and performing. Good foundation for outreach.
7	Post-Meeting Follow-Up	User's email (fundraising)	After investor meeting: 1hr, 3 days, 1 week	28 sent, 71% reply rate	Excellent reply rate. 3-step sequence working well.
8	Investor Update Newsletter	User's email	Monthly cadence, pulls KPIs from dashboard	6 editions sent (PAUSED)	Currently paused. Should auto-resume. Strong retention tool.
9	Due Diligence Automation	User's email (fundraising)	DD process: access, checklist, reminders, completion	4-step active sequence	Active. Good automation for a complex workflow.
10	Warm Intro Request	User's email (fundraising)	Network-based: blurb, send, reminder	42 sent, 62% success rate	Strong success rate. 3-step sequence.

Design & Copy Issues Identified

- No HTML templates: Update emails from team@founderconsole.ai are plain text with no branding, no CTA buttons, and no visual hierarchy. They look like internal engineering changelogs, not product communications.

- Inconsistent sender identity: Two sender addresses found: 'Nikita from FounderConsole <noreply@founderconsole.ai>' and 'FounderConsole Team <team@founderconsole.ai>'. Needs consolidation.
- No email preferences page: Users cannot opt in/out of specific email types. No unsubscribe link visible (GDPR/CAN-SPAM compliance risk).
- No mobile optimization: Plain-text emails render poorly on mobile. No responsive HTML templates detected.
- Weekly briefing requires manual trigger: Users must click 'Send Weekly Briefing' in the app. Should be an automated weekly cron job.
- Alerts may be in-app only: The 6 configurable alerts appear to generate in-app notifications (bell icon) but email delivery is not confirmed or toggleable.

3. Gap Analysis: What's Missing

Benchmarked against PLG SaaS best practices, the following critical email categories are entirely absent from FounderConsole:

Category	Missing Emails	Impact	Priority
Authentication	Email verification, password reset, magic link login, 2FA codes	Users cannot recover accounts. Security risk.	P0
Welcome & Onboarding	Welcome email, setup guide (3-step), sample company prompt, first simulation nudge, activation celebration	86% of users decide in Week 1. No emails = no activation support.	P0
Feature Adoption	First simulation congrats, first board deck, first Copilot use, integration connected, cap table complete	Users discover features by accident. No guided adoption.	P1
Engagement Milestones	10th simulation, first GO decision, shared a report, invited team member, 30-day anniversary	No celebration = no dopamine = lower retention.	P1
Billing & Payments	Payment receipt, failed payment dunning (3-step), plan upgrade/downgrade, trial expiring, trial expired	Revenue leakage. Dunning alone can recover 5-10% of churn.	P0
Usage Alerts	Approaching plan limit, simulation quota warning, Copilot questions running low	Missed upsell triggers. Users hit walls with no upgrade path.	P1
Admin & Security	New device login, password changed, team member added/removed, data export requested	Trust & compliance. Enterprise customers expect this.	P2
User Re-engagement	Inactive 3 days (trial), inactive 7 days, inactive 30 days, churned user win-back	No re-engagement = silent churn. High-impact, low-effort.	P0
Product Updates	New feature announcements, changelog digest, monthly product roundup	Users unaware of improvements. Reduces perceived value.	P2
Collaboration	Invited to workspace, shared simulation, shared board deck, comment/mention notification	Blocks viral growth. Team features need email triggers.	P1

Total gap: ~32 missing email triggers across 10 categories. The P0 items (authentication, onboarding, billing, re-engagement) should be implemented before any public launch or paid tier activation.

4. Complete Email Trigger Map

The following 42-trigger email system covers the full user lifecycle. Emails are organized by lifecycle stage, with exact triggers, timing, and goals specified.

Stage 1: Authentication & Account (Transactional)

#	Email	Trigger	Timing	Goal
1	Email Verification	User signs up	Instant	Verify email, confirm account creation
2	Welcome Email	Email verified	Instant	First impression. Link to dashboard + 3-step setup guide
3	Password Reset	User requests reset	Instant	Secure link, 1-hour expiry
4	Magic Link Login	User requests magic link	Instant	Passwordless login option
5	Password Changed	Password updated	Instant	Security confirmation + 'not you?' link
6	New Device Login	Login from new device/IP	Instant	Security alert with device details

Stage 2: Onboarding Sequence (Behavior-Based)

#	Email	Trigger	Timing	Goal
7	Quick Start Guide	Account created, data not entered	+4 hours	Show 3-step wizard: Know Your Truth, Simulate, Decide
8	Data Input Nudge	Signed up but no financial data entered	+24 hours	Link to /data-input. Show sample company option.
9	First Simulation Prompt	Financial data entered but no simulation run	+2 hours after data	Explain Monte Carlo value. CTA: Run Your First Simulation
10	Activation Celebration	First simulation completed	Instant	Congrats + show P10/P50/P90 highlights + next steps
11	Copilot Introduction	Simulation done but Copilot not used	+24 hours	Show Copilot capabilities. CTA: Ask Your AI CFO a Question
12	Setup Complete	All 3 wizard steps done	Instant	Celebrate full activation. Introduce advanced features.
13	Stalled Onboarding	Signed up 72 hours ago, wizard incomplete	+72 hours	Offer help. Show sample company shortcut. Book a call CTA.

Stage 3: Feature Adoption & Engagement

#	Email	Trigger	Timing
1 4	First Board Deck Generated	User creates first board deck	Instant — celebrate + share tips
1 5	First Cap Table Complete	Cap table has 3+ stakeholders	Instant — show dilution simulator
1 6	Integration Connected	First data integration linked (Zoho, Stripe, etc.)	Instant — show auto-sync benefits
1 7	What-If Explorer Tips	User ran 3+ simulations	+24 hours — advanced slider tips
1 8	Fundraising Module Intro	User has not visited /fundraising after 7 days	Day 7 — introduce fundraising automation
1 9	Weekly Feature Tip	User active but using <30% of features	Weekly — one feature spotlight per email
2 0	Health Check Nudge	User hasn't run Health Check in 30 days	Monthly — 'Your financial health checkup is due'

Stage 4: Recurring Notifications (Existing + Enhanced)

#	Email	Trigger	Enhancement Needed
2 1	Daily Briefing Email	Every morning, 8am user local time	NEW: Needs actual email delivery, not just in-app banner
2 2	Weekly Briefing Email	Every Monday, 9am user local time	FIX: Automate. Remove manual trigger button. Add unsubscribe.
2 3	Burn Spike Alert	Monthly burn increases >15%	FIX: Confirm email delivery. Add email toggle in /alerts settings.
2 4	MRR Drop Alert	MRR drops >5%	FIX: Same — ensure email delivery + preference toggle
2 5	Churn Spike Alert	Churn increases >50%	FIX: Same
2 6	Runway Warning	Runway drops below 12 months	FIX: Same — this is the most critical alert. Must be email.
2 7	Runway Caution	Runway drops below 18 months	FIX: Same
2 8	Growth Slowdown Alert	Growth rate decreases >30%	FIX: Same

Stage 5: Billing & Payment (When Paid Tiers Launch)

#	Email	Trigger	Timing
2 9	Payment Receipt	Successful payment processed	Instant — invoice + plan details
3 0	Failed Payment (Soft)	First payment failure	Instant — 'Please update your card'
3 1	Failed Payment (Urgent)	Second payment failure	+3 days — 'Your account may be downgraded'
3 2	Failed Payment (Final)	Third payment failure	+7 days — 'Last chance before account changes'
3 3	Plan Upgraded	User upgrades to higher tier	Instant — celebrate + new feature highlights
3 4	Plan Downgraded	User downgrades	Instant — acknowledge + offer to help
3 5	Trial Expiring Soon	Trial ends in 3 days	-3 days — show value used + upgrade CTA

#	Email	Trigger	Timing
3 6	Trial Expired	Trial has ended	Instant — 'Upgrade to keep your data and simulations'

Stage 6: Re-engagement & Win-Back

#	Email	Trigger	Content Strategy
3 7	Inactive 3 Days (Trial)	No login for 3 days during trial	Low-friction: 'Your simulation is waiting' + quick-win CTA
3 8	Inactive 7 Days	No login for 7 days (any user)	Check-in: 'Did you know about [feature]?' + help offer
3 9	Inactive 30 Days	No login for 30 days	Value summary: 'Here is what changed since you left' + data still safe
4 0	Churned User Win-Back	User cancelled or downgraded 30+ days ago	Traction update: new features, customer stories, re-activation offer

Stage 7: Collaboration & Viral

#	Email	Trigger
4 1	Workspace Invitation	User invites team member to workspace — invitee gets email with CTA to join
4 2	Shared Simulation/Report	User shares a simulation, board deck, or health check — recipient gets email with view link

5. Email Template Redesign Specifications

All FounderConsole emails should follow a consistent design system. Below are the design specs and copy guidelines for the redesigned email templates.

Design System for Emails

Element	Specification
Max Width	600px — standard for email clients
Background	#F7F6F2 (outer) / #FFFFFF (content card)
Primary Color	#01696F (Teal — buttons, links, headers)
Text Color	#28251D (body) / #7A7974 (muted)
Font Stack	system-ui, -apple-system, 'Segoe UI', Roboto, sans-serif
Header	FounderConsole logo (left) + 'View in Browser' link (right)
Footer	Unsubscribe link + Email Preferences + Company address (CAN-SPAM)
CTA Buttons	44px height, 16px padding, #01696F background, white text, 8px border-radius
Preheader Text	Always set — hidden text that appears in inbox preview
Dark Mode	Add @media (prefers-color-scheme: dark) with inverted colors
Mobile	Single column below 480px. Min tap target 44x44px.

Template 1: Welcome Email (Post-Verification)

Subject: Welcome to FounderConsole — your AI CFO is ready

Preheader: Get your first financial simulation running in under 5 minutes

Section	Content
Hero	Hi [First Name], welcome to FounderConsole. You just joined [X] founders who use probabilistic simulations to make smarter decisions.
3-Step CTA Block	Step 1: Enter your financials (2 min) Step 2: Run your first simulation (1 min) Step 3: Get your GO/NO-GO score. Each step has a direct-link CTA button.
Social Proof	'[Company] ran 47 simulations in their first month and raised their Series A 3 weeks ahead of schedule.' — small testimonial block
Help Block	Need help? Reply to this email or book a 15-min setup call: [Calendly link]
Footer	Unsubscribe Email Preferences FounderConsole, Inc.

Template 2: Activation Celebration

Subject: Your first simulation is complete — here's what the numbers say

Preheader: P10/P50/P90 results are in. See your GO/NO-GO score.

Section	Content
Hero	Congratulations, [First Name]! You just ran your first Monte Carlo simulation with 500 scenarios.
Results Snapshot	Inline KPI cards: P10 Runway: [X] months P50 Runway: [X] months P90 Runway: [X] months GO/NO-GO: [Score]. Pull data from the simulation results.
Next Steps	CTA 1: Try the What-If Explorer (adjust sliders, see impact) CTA 2: Generate a Board Deck CTA 3: Ask the AI Copilot a question
Pro Tip	'Tip: Adjust the burn rate slider by -10% and see how your P50 shifts. Most founders find 2-3 key levers that change everything.'

Template 3: Weekly Briefing (Redesigned)

Subject: [Company Name] Weekly Briefing — [Date Range]

Preheader: MRR [up/down] [X]%, Runway at [Y] months, [Z] alerts triggered

Section	Content
Header	Weekly Financial Briefing for [Company Name] — Week of [Date]
KPI Dashboard	4 inline cards: MRR (\$X, +Y%), Burn Rate (\$X/mo, trend), Runway (X months, status), Cash (\$X remaining). Each with green/red delta arrows.
Alerts Fired	If any alerts triggered this week, list them: 'Burn Spike: Monthly burn increased 18% (threshold: 15%)'. Red highlight for critical.
Simulation Suggestion	'Based on this week: We recommend re-running your runway simulation with updated burn data.' CTA: Re-Run Simulation
AI Insight	One AI-generated insight: 'At current trajectory, you have a 72% probability of reaching 18 months runway. Consider reducing headcount growth by 5% to increase to 85%.'
Quick Actions	CTA row: View Dashboard Run Simulation Generate Board Deck

Template 4: Threshold Alert Email

Subject: Alert: [Alert Type] triggered for [Company Name]

Preheader: Your [metric] crossed the [threshold] threshold. Action may be needed.

Section	Content
Alert Banner	Red/orange header bar with alert icon + alert name (e.g., 'BURN SPIKE ALERT'). Immediately communicates urgency.
What Happened	'Your monthly burn increased by 23%, exceeding your 15% threshold. Current monthly burn: \$2.4M (was: \$1.95M).'
Context	'This is the first time this alert has fired in 3 months. The primary driver appears to be [AI-identified cause if available].'
Recommended Action	'Run a new simulation to see how this impacts your runway probability.' CTA: Run Simulation Now
Alert Settings	'Manage this alert: Adjust threshold Snooze for 7 days Disable this alert' — inline links

Template 5: Failed Payment Dunning (3-Step)

Step	Subject	Tone	Content
Attempt 1 (Day 0)	Quick heads up: your payment didn't go through	Friendly, no pressure	Card may have expired. Update payment in 1 click. [Update Card CTA]
Attempt 2 (Day 3)	Your FounderConsole account needs attention	Concerned, helpful	Second attempt failed. Your simulations and data are safe, but access may be interrupted. [Update Card CTA]
Attempt 3 (Day 7)	Final notice: update your payment to keep [Company] data	Urgent but respectful	Last reminder before downgrade. All your simulation history, cap table, and board decks remain saved. [Update Card CTA] or [Contact Support]

Template 6: Re-engagement (Inactive 7 Days)

Subject: We miss you, [First Name] — your dashboard has new insights

Preheader: Your financial data has been updating while you were away.

Section	Content
Opening	Hi [First Name], it's been a week since you last logged in. Your data has been updating — here's a quick peek at what's new:
Data Summary	Auto-generated mini dashboard: MRR, burn, runway. Shows deltas since last login.
Feature Highlight	Spotlight one feature they haven't used: 'Have you tried the What-If Explorer? Drag the revenue growth slider and watch your runway probability change in real time.'
CTA	Primary: 'See Your Updated Dashboard' Secondary: 'Need help? Reply to this email.'

6. Technical Infrastructure Recommendations

Email Sending Architecture

- Transactional emails (auth, receipts, alerts): Use a dedicated transactional email service — Postmark, AWS SES, or SendGrid Transactional. Must deliver in <5 seconds. Separate IP/domain from marketing.
- Marketing/lifecycle emails (onboarding, engagement, re-engagement): Use Customer.io, Loops.so, or Resend for behavior-triggered sequences. Must integrate with product event tracking.
- Fundraising automation emails: These already exist in the platform. Consider whether to keep them in-house or migrate to a dedicated email tool for better deliverability tracking.
- Event tracking pipeline: Every user action that triggers an email must fire a server-side event (e.g., 'simulation_completed', 'cap_table_updated', 'alert_triggered'). Use Segment or a custom event bus to route events to the email platform.

Sender Configuration

Email Type	From Address	Reply-To
Transactional (auth, billing)	no-reply@founderconsole.ai	support@founderconsole.ai
Product notifications (alerts, briefings)	alerts@founderconsole.ai	support@founderconsole.ai
Onboarding & engagement	team@founderconsole.ai	team@founderconsole.ai (monitored)
Fundraising sequences	User's own email (existing)	User's email
Product updates / changelog	updates@founderconsole.ai	team@founderconsole.ai

Compliance Requirements

- CAN-SPAM (US): Every marketing email must include physical mailing address, one-click unsubscribe, and clear sender identification. Unsubscribe must be honored within 10 business days.
- GDPR (EU/UK): Requires explicit consent for marketing emails. Transactional emails are permitted without consent. Must provide data export and deletion on request.
- DKIM + SPF + DMARC: All three must be configured on founderconsole.ai domain. Gmail and Yahoo require these for bulk senders (5,000+ emails/day) as of 2024.
- One-click unsubscribe: RFC 8058 List-Unsubscribe-Post header required for bulk senders. Gmail displays an unsubscribe button in the inbox if this header is present.
- Email preferences page: Build /settings/email-preferences allowing users to toggle: Daily Briefing, Weekly Briefing, Alert Emails, Feature Tips, Product Updates, Fundraising Sequences. Each toggle

should map to a suppression list in the email platform.

7. Implementation Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Emails to Build	Effort	Impact
Phase 0: Compliance Fix	Week 1	Add unsubscribe to all existing emails. Build /settings/email-preferences page. Configure DKIM/SPF/DMARC.	2-3 days	Eliminate legal risk
Phase 1: Transactional	Week 2-3	Email verification (#1), Welcome (#2), Password reset (#3), Password changed (#5). Build HTML email template system.	1-2 weeks	Account security + first impression
Phase 2: Onboarding	Week 3-5	Quick Start (#7), Data Input Nudge (#8), First Simulation Prompt (#9), Activation Celebration (#10), Copilot Intro (#11), Stalled Onboarding (#13). Set up event tracking.	2-3 weeks	Activation rate: target 2x lift
Phase 3: Alerts to Email	Week 5-6	Confirm and fix email delivery for all 6 alert types (#23-28). Automate weekly briefing (#22). Build alert email template.	1 week	Retention + trust
Phase 4: Billing	Pre-launch of paid tiers	Payment receipt (#29), 3-step dunning (#30-32), plan changes (#33-34), trial reminders (#35-36).	1-2 weeks	Revenue protection (5-10% churn recovery)
Phase 5: Engagement	Month 2-3	Feature adoption emails (#14-20), milestone celebrations, weekly feature tips.	2-3 weeks	Feature discovery + retention
Phase 6: Re-engagement	Month 2-3	Inactive 3/7/30 day sequences (#37-39), churned user win-back (#40).	1-2 weeks	Reactivate 5-15% of lapsed users
Phase 7: Collaboration	Month 3-4	Workspace invite (#41), shared report notifications (#42). Enable viral loops.	1-2 weeks	Viral coefficient improvement

KPIs to Track

Metric	Target	Measurement
Email delivery rate	>98%	Transactional emails delivered within 5 seconds
Onboarding activation rate	40%+ complete wizard in 7 days	% of new users who run first simulation within 7 days
Weekly briefing open rate	>50%	Above B2B SaaS average (40%)
Alert email click-through	>15%	Users clicking 'Run Simulation' from alert emails
Dunning recovery rate	5-10% of failed payments recovered	% of soft-declined payments recovered through email sequence
Re-engagement reactivation	5-15% of inactive users return	% of 7-day inactive users who log in within 48 hours of email

Metric	Target	Measurement
Unsubscribe rate	<0.5% per email	Below industry average. Monitor weekly.
Spam complaint rate	<0.1%	Must stay below 0.3% (Gmail threshold)

Summary: FounderConsole needs 42 email triggers across 7 lifecycle stages. The existing fundraising automation (5 sequences) is strong. The critical gaps are in authentication, onboarding, billing, and re-engagement — all of which directly impact activation, retention, and revenue. Phase 0 (compliance) and Phase 1-2 (transactional + onboarding) should be completed before any public launch or paid tier activation. The full system can be built in 8-12 weeks with a dedicated engineer and a product marketer.